

a cleaning cloth to wipe out the outsides of your PC. To clean your keyboard, use a dust blower or Q-tip to really get in deep. For the fans of your PC, a few blasts of compressed air does the trick. Cleaning out fans also helps avoid slowdown issues caused due to overheating. Moving on, to clean any internal component, first, disconnect it from the motherboard or power supply and then go ahead with compressed air or Q-tips as needed.

In a similar manner, you can clean most of your gadgets, but remember to always read or watch a tutorial before doing so in order to avoid damaging the product. Here's an article that briefly explains how to clean most gadgets – <https://digit.in/gadget-love>. Regularly cleaning your gadgets can greatly extend their lifespan and keep them looking and feeling relatively new.

MAKING YOUR DEVICE FEEL NEW AGAIN

Laptops and smartphones have a certain lifespan and start slowing down considerably as they inch closer to the end of their lifespan. However, some practices can make them slow down prematurely, causing them to feel old and sluggish. Nevertheless, there are things you can do to make your device feel new again; let's look at some examples. Due to space constraints, we will only be covering smartphones and laptops/PCs, but these are usually the gadgets that tend to show signs of age most.

SMARTPHONES

Clean your storage

Decluttering the local storage on your phone is very important in order to make it feel snappy. Most smartphones come with a built-in Files or storage manager app that can be used for this. Or else, you can just download Google's free *Files Go* app. Such apps usually come with suggestions to remove possible junk files, duplicate files, downloaded files, and large files. You can remove these to free up some space on your phone. If you use Google's *File Go* app, the app even sug-

gests users remove image and video files that have already been uploaded to the cloud – *Google Photos*. Also, if you have a live photos feature, like on iOS, ensure to turn it off since the files take up unnecessary space then. On iOS devices, go to Storage in your system settings and you'll see all your apps, in order of how much space



Image Source: Geckoandfly

Get rid of the clutter!

they use. Look for apps you don't use and simply select 'Delete App' in the app storage page.

Another good practice is to delete single-use or unused apps. Too many apps slow down smartphones by running processes in the background and using up resources, so it makes sense to clear the ones you don't use. The *Files Go* app by Google suggests less frequently-used apps that can be uninstalled. Even without this app, you can head over to the 'Apps' section of your system settings and then look for all your installed apps.

OVERHAUL THE LOOK OF YOUR SMARTPHONE

1. Change up the wallpaper – Try apps such as 4K AMOLED wallpapers and Google Wallpapers, or websites such as Unsplash and Wallhaven to change up the look of your home and lock screen
2. Try out different widgets – Experimenting with widgets can really make your device feel fresh again. Try out some widgets such as TickTick, Countdown Days, Overdrop Weather, and others for Android. For iOS, you can try widgets such as Headspace, MemoWidget, Color Widgets, and GoodTask.
3. Experiment with new launchers on Android – If you're looking for a complete visual revamp without rooting, launchers are excellent for that. Some excellent launchers include Lawnchair, Action Launcher, Nova Launcher, and Apex Launcher.
4. Try out different icon packs on Android – Using a launcher, you can also switch out the default icons on your phone. Check out icon packs such as Viral and Delta on the Play Store to get a fresh look.
5. Third-party apps – Why not try some excellent third-party alternatives to default apps on your phone? You can switch out apps such as email, browser, calendar, weather app, and others with plenty of amazing options on the App Store or Play Store.

Simply look over them and uninstall the ones that aren't being used often. You can also use lightweight app alternatives such as *Facebook Lite* instead of *Facebook*. Also, if a particular app you use cannot be uninstalled, you can disable it in the settings menu. You can always enable it again, should you ever need to. However, don't go about disabling important system-level utility apps such as *Carrier Services*, *Google Play Services*, and *SIM Toolkit*.

Clear the memory cache and wipe cache partition on Android

Cached data for apps allow them to load more quickly, however, this can seriously affect the overall performance of your phone over time, when the cached data builds up too much. Additionally, the phone also stores cached data for apps that are no longer in use, essentially wasting resources. Clearing up cached data from time-to-time can help speed up your phone and reduce erratic behaviour. If you wish to clear cached data for selected apps, head over to *Settings* > *Apps* and then tap on the relevant app in the 'All' tab. Next, just hit clear cache. If you wish to delete cached data from all of your apps at once, head over to *Settings* > *Storage* and then